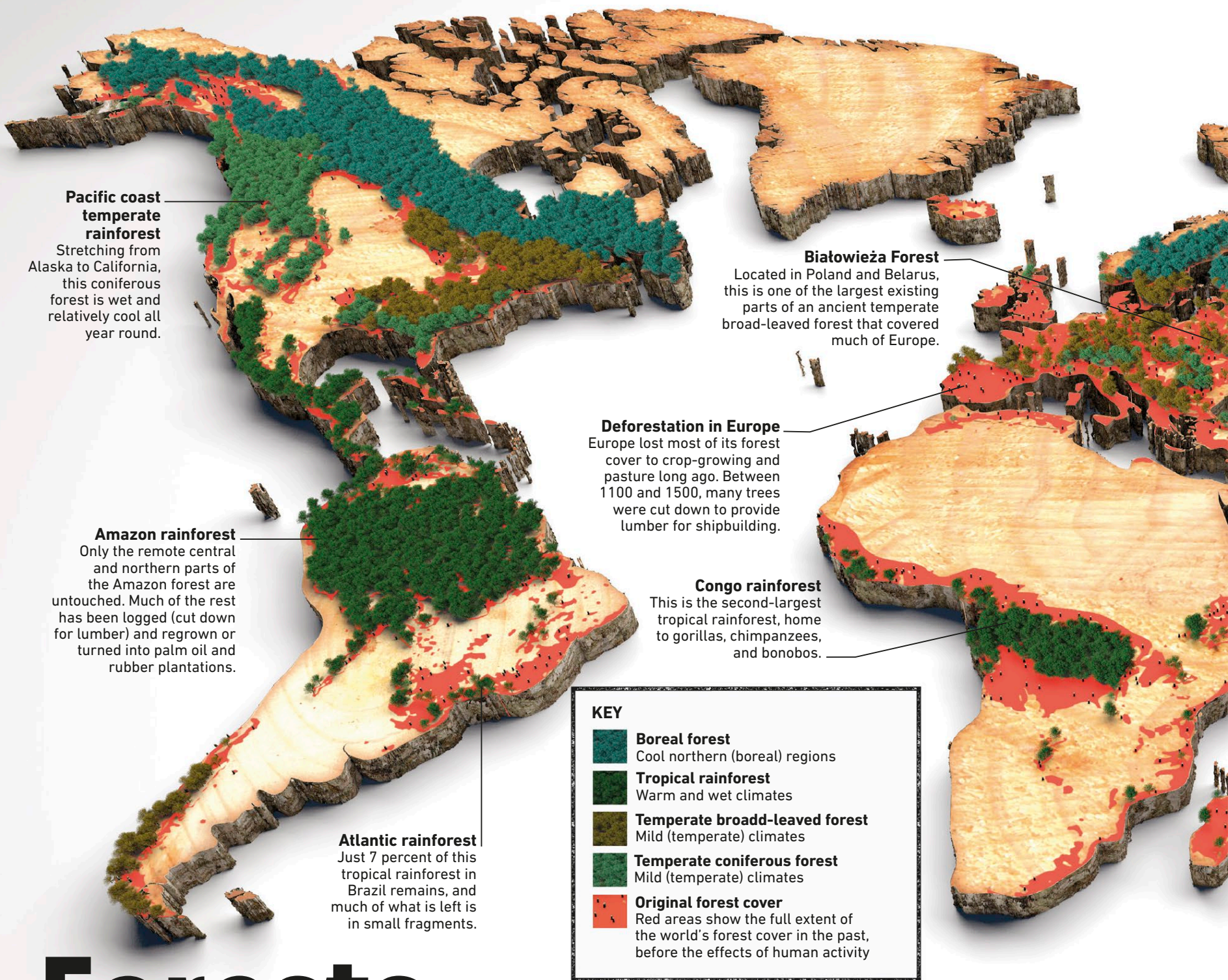




Forests

Forests are vital to life on Earth. They make the air breathable, protect the soil, and preserve fresh water supplies. But they are disappearing—and while efforts are being made to slow deforestation, about 25 million acres are still lost each year.

Types of forests

Forests differ according to climate. Each type of forest has its own distinct collection of trees, forest-floor plants, and animal life. Tropical rainforests are the most diverse—30 percent of all plant and animal species live in the Amazon alone. Some tropical forests are evergreen, while in others the trees lose their leaves in the dry season.



Temperate broad-leaved
Deciduous trees, such as oak and beech. Herbs, ferns, and shrubs on the forest floor.